

Fancy Cello Chords

and Their Voicings

C G D A



<https://github.com/linenoise/voicings>

Movable Shapes

Cello closed, so they move

shape root on bottom example

fifths

00xx	C	R	11xx = Db5
x00x	G	R	x11x = Ab5
xx00	D	R	xx11 = Eb5
2xx0	C	R	3xx1 = Eb5

major

002x	C	R	113x = Db
x002	G	R	x113 = Ab
30x1	C	R	41x2 = E

minor

001x	C	R	112x = Dbm
x001	G	R	x112 = Abm
2x30	C	R	3x41 = Ebm

- Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret.
- Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone.
- Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

Root Positions

Cello

	C	G	D	A
C	0	5	10	3
Db	1	6	11	4
D	2	7	0	5
Eb	3	8	1	6
E	4	9	2	7
F	5	10	3	8
Gb	6	11	4	9
G	7	0	5	10
Ab	8	1	6	11
A	9	2	7	0
Bb	10	3	8	1
B	11	4	9	2

- Fret for the root of each key on each string. Everything else is measured from there.

Patterns

Cello counted from the root

Root + fifth + octave The default. Works under

anything in the key.

degree **R 5 8**

string R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R0 R-2

Major arpeggio Major, maj7, 6.

degree **R 5 8 3**

string R 1+R 2+R 2+R

fret R0 R0 R-2 R2

Minor arpeggio Minor, m7, m6.

degree **R 5 8 b3**

string R 1+R 2+R 2+R

fret R0 R0 R-2 R1

Dominant seventh Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to

the four.

degree **R 5 b7 3**

string R 1+R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R0 R3 R2

Minor seventh The two and the six chord.

degree **R 5 b7 b3**

string R 1+R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R0 R3 R1

Walking approach Leading into the next chord.

degree **R 5 6 b7**

string R 1+R 1+R 1+R

fret R0 R0 R2 R3

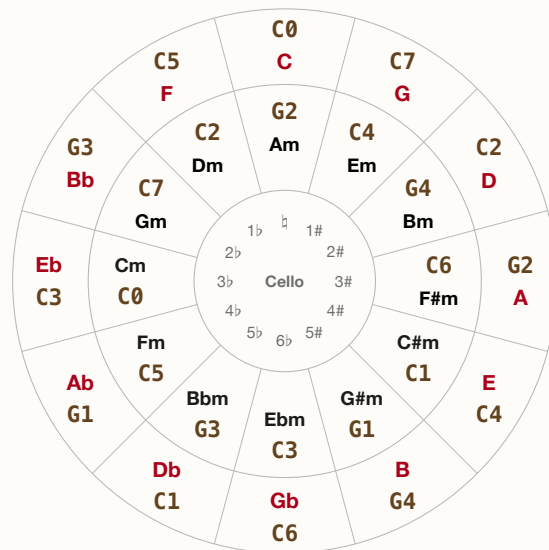
Cello the major scale, degree by degree

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
C	C	D	E	F	G	A	B
D^b	D ^b	E ^b	F	G ^b	A ^b	B ^b	C
D	D	E	F [#]	G	A	B	C [#]
E^b	E ^b	F	G	A ^b	B ^b	C	D
E	E	F [#]	G [#]	A	B	C [#]	D [#]
F	F	G	A	B ^b	C	D	E
G^b	G ^b	A ^b	B ^b	C ^b	D ^b	E ^b	F
G	G	A	B	C	D	E	F [#]
A^b	A ^b	B ^b	C	D ^b	E ^b	F	G
A	A	B	C [#]	D	E	F [#]	G [#]
B^b	B ^b	C	D	E ^b	F	G	A
B	B	C [#]	D [#]	E	F [#]	G [#]	A [#]

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

Cello

Circle of Fifths



String and fret for each root: **G3** is the third position on the G string.
Lowest that falls under the hand.

Tunings

Cello **C** **G** **D** **A**

Tuned in fifths, a fifth below the mandolin. Viola is the same four notes an octave up, so these pages serve both.

What to Play Under

Cello degrees from the root

major	R 3 5	°7	R b3 b5 6
m	R b3 5	m7b5	R b3 b5 b7
5	R 5	7sus4	R 4 5 b7
+	R 3 #5	7b5	R 3 b5 b7
°	R b3 b5	7#5	R 3 #5 b7
sus2	R 2 5		
sus4	R 4 5	9	R 9 3 5 b7
		maj9	R 9 3 5 7
6	R 3 5 6	m9	R 9 b3 5 b7
m6	R b3 5 6	add9	R 9 3 5
6/9	R 9 3 5 6	madd9	R 9 b3 5
		7b9	R b9 3 5 b7
7	R 3 5 b7	7#9	R b3 3 5 b7
maj7	R 3 5 7	m11	R 9 b3 4 5
m7	R b3 5 b7		b7

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.
Add the tone that names the chord, the **b3** or
the **b7**, only when it wants hearing.
The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.

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Source, corrections and a printable copy:

<https://github.com/linenoise/voicings>

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